

District Student Council Bylaws

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10/27/26

SCHOOLS REPRESENTED:

Alliance, Benson, Cleveland, Franklin, Grant, Ida B. Wells-Barnett, Jefferson, Lincoln, Leodis V. McDaniel, Metropolitan Learning Center, and Roosevelt.

PURPOSE:

The mission of the DSC is to represent all students across PPS in an advocacy and action-oriented capacity.

DSC REPRESENTATIVES:

DSC Representatives are expected to:

1. Attend regularly scheduled DSC meetings to the best of their ability.
2. Establish a relationship and maintain regular communication with their school's affinity groups, clubs, school's ASB or equivalent governing body, if such a governing body exists.
3. Attend and support the planning of the PPS Student Summit.
4. Attend and/or watch at least one School Board meeting a year.
5. Ensure their school elects or appoints at least one representative for the succeeding year.

ATTENDANCE:

1. Regularly scheduled meetings occur biweekly. To maintain good standing, DSC representatives are expected to attend 80% (13/16) of these meetings in order to receive 1 elective credit and stoles for seniors.
2. If a representative cannot make a specific meeting, they are expected to communicate the reason for the absence to the staff liaison prior to the meeting. The staff liaison will ensure that the Chair is informed of absences.

3. Remember that as student representatives, you are representing your student body, and so attendance must be prioritized.

SESSIONS & REPRESENTATIVE TERMS:

1. Regular Sessions of the DSC shall last from most high school students' first day of school through the final day of the physical school year.
    a. The DSC shall also meet for a Summer Session between July 1st and most high schoolers' first day of school, during which time the DSC shall convene less frequently.
2. Representatives shall serve a term of one Regular Session and one Summer Session.
3. Newly elected or appointed representatives shall take office upon the end of their predecessor's term.
4. Schools are encouraged to hold DSC elections or appointments either in the fall or the spring, to allow for smooth transitions at the beginning of new DSC sessions.
5. Representatives may serve a maximum of three terms, so long as they are re-elected or re-appointed upon the end of each term.

MEETINGS:

1. It will be the responsibility of the Leadership team to schedule meetings.
2. A majority of DSC representatives can also schedule meetings.
3. Agreement of the Chair and Vice Chair is required to cancel a meeting.
4. Agendas will be created by the leadership team before meetings.
    a. If a DSC representative wants to add items to the agenda, the representative shall submit this request to the Leadership Team. A majority of the Leadership Team is required to approve this request.

Meeting Types:

1. Regularly scheduled meetings: These meetings are scheduled at least a month in advance, but will be scheduled at the beginning of each year and adjusted slightly, as necessary.
    a. These will occur before School Board meetings or on a bi-weekly basis, as determined by the Leadership team.
    b. All DSC representatives are expected to attend.
    c. These meetings are the only meetings that will count for attendance towards receiving an elective credit.
2. Subcommittee meetings: These meetings will typically be recurring over a given period of time. Such meetings will focus on a specific topic important to the DSC at that time. These meetings will be for DSC representatives that are interested in that topic. Those who express interest and are appointed to that subcommittee will be expected to be in attendance. All DSC representatives will be invited to these meetings.
    a. Suggestions will be developed at these meetings and reported at the next regularly scheduled meeting. At the regularly scheduled meeting, the subcommittee will be given guidance on how to best proceed, and any vote proposed by the subcommittee is required to be on the agenda and thus be voted upon.
    b. No resolutions shall be passed at subcommittee meetings.
3. Executive session meetings: These meetings will occur when the DSC does not feel it appropriate for the staff liaison to be present. These meetings will not be recurring.
    a. An executive session can be called at any time by the Chair in a recurring meeting of any type.
    b. If the meeting is called in advance and is not during any other DSC related meeting, then it must be scheduled 24 hours in advance.
    c. The Chair can decide to go into an executive session meeting, or the majority of present DSC councilors can also do so.
    d. No decisions can be made in an executive session meeting.

Meeting Etiquette:

1. Regularly scheduled meetings may be recorded. If meetings are recorded, it will be the entire meeting.
    a. The Leadership Team shall ensure that all publicly available recordings and documents are provided to each High School's newspaper in a timely fashion, when requested.
2. During official meetings, the District Student Council should make efforts to follow, to a degree deemed appropriate by meeting context setting, Robert's Rules of Order.

SUBCOMITTEES:

1. Subcommittees will be composed of at least 3 representatives.
2. Subcommittees will be formed at the recommendation of the Chair or a DSC member, and approved through resolution by the DSC.
3. When voting on the resolution, at least 3 representatives shall volunteer to be on the subcommittee. They will be expected to attend all said subcommittee meetings.

VOTING:

1. If a vote is initiated, all representatives present at the meeting must cast their vote during the meeting or abstain from the vote.
2. Once a vote is cast and counted, representatives may not change their vote.
3. To pass anything (resolutions, positions, board matters, and all other matters) the motion must be approved by a majority of voting-eligible DSC representatives.
4. In the event of a tie, the Chair's vote will be cast as a tiebreaker.
5. All voting results will be recorded in the notes, including who voted for what, except for when voting on Leadership positions in the DSC.

Types of Votes:

1. Voting for Positions: There is no quorum needed to initiate this vote.
    a. Representatives may vote after the meeting has occurred, but only after listening to the candidate's proposed remarks.
    b. All DSC representatives are expected to vote on this matter.
    c. For the positions of Chair, Vice Chair, and Secretary, all votes shall be cast by anonymous ballots.
2. Voting on Board Matter: A quorum of 51% of DSC representatives is needed to initiate a vote.
    a. DSC representatives may submit their vote before the meeting, if they are unable to attend the meeting.
    b. These are public votes.
3. Resolution Passing: The quorum for this vote is 51%.
    a. DSC representatives may cast their vote before or after the meeting if they are unable to attend.
    b. DSC representatives must cast a vote.
    c. All votes must be cast prior to the start of the next regularly scheduled DSC meeting.
    d. These votes are public.

Voting Procedure:

1. The Chair of a meeting may bring an agenda item up for consideration by requesting a motion and receiving a second from the DSC.
2. Discussion is hence opened up, where the DSC is given due time to discuss the motion.
3. The Chair may then call for a vote on the matter.

LEADERSHIP:

1. The DSC shall elect a Chair, Vice Chair, Secretary, and Corresponding Secretary to serve for the duration of the regular session.
2. Elections for the Chair Position shall be held in early May of the previous year.
    a. The elected individual does not assume the title of Chair until the beginning of the next regular session.
    b. The Summer Session shall be used for Onboarding between the current Chair and the Chair Elect.
3. Elections for the Vice Chair, Secretary, and Corresponding Secretary positions shall take place at the second DSC meeting in October.
    a. In the event that most schools lack representation on the DSC by the second meeting in October, or the DSC feels there isn't adequate representation of the PPS student body on the DSC, this vote can be delayed until the second meeting in November.
4. DSC representatives must state their intent to run for positions at least one week prior to the election by informing the Chair and Staff Liaison.
    a. At the election meeting, candidates will give a speech.
    b. Candidates may also submit a video speech, which will be played during the meeting.
    c. Candidates will focus on why they would be a good fit for the position.
    d. A minimum of two questions from the DSC must be answered by the candidate regarding their platform.
    e. There shall not be any campaigning outside of prepared remarks.
5. Representatives cannot hold multiple roles on the leadership team.
6. All Leadership members are expected to show up to all leadership meetings; if they are unable to attend, they shall inform their leadership colleagues 24 hours in advance.

Leadership Roles:

1. Student Representative to the Board of Education, Chair:
   To qualify to run for the position of Chair, representatives must have one year of experience on the DSC.
   Their roles and responsibilities shall be to:
   a. Attend Board of Education meetings and to represent the diverse voices of the district student body at such meetings.
   b. Cast their unofficial vote on the Board in the best interest of students.
   c. Set the DSC meeting agendas in collaboration with the rest of the Leadership Team.
   d. Chair DSC meetings.
   e. Provide the DSC with updates and seek feedback regarding board matters.
2. Vice Chair:
   Their roles and responsibilities shall be to:
   a. Chair meetings in the absence of the Student Representative.
   b. Attend School Board meetings when the Chair is unable to attend, and represent the voices of all of the student body at such meetings.
   c. Set DSC meeting agendas in conjunction with the rest of the Leadership Team.
   d. Serve as an advisor to the Chair.
   e. Assume all responsibilities of the Chair in their absence.
3. Secretary:
   Their roles and responsibilities shall be to:
   a. Take notes at DSC meetings.
   b. Set DSC meeting agendas in conjunction with the rest of the Leadership Team.
   c. Manage the shared DSC Google Drive, which shall contain all DSC materials.
   d. Distribute necessary meeting materials to the DSC.
4. Corresponding Secretary:

Their roles and responsibilities shall be to:

a. Manage the DSC's Instagram, Twitter, TikTok, and other social media accounts.
b. Set DSC meeting agendas in conjunction with the rest of the Leadership Team.

5. Other roles:
   Additional leadership roles can be proposed by the Leadership Team and must be voted on by the DSC.

Staff Liaison:

1. The Staff Liaison's main role should be to support the DSC in the pursuit of greater student voice.
2. The Staff Liaison shall not act or make decisions on behalf of the DSC without explicit consent.
3. The Staff Liaison will have no voting power and shall respect the autonomy of the Chair and the DSC.
4. The Staff Liaison will make sure that both the DSC and themselves are informed of the happenings of the district.
5. The Staff Liaison is responsible for reserving conference rooms at the District office known as the Prophet Education Center (PEC).
6. The Staff Liaison is responsible for ensuring food/snacks are available at regular meetings.

ONBOARDING:

Onboarding the Chair Elect:

1. Onboarding shall occur the remainder of the Regular Session as well as the Summer Session following the election of the new Chair.
2. The Chair Elect shall be invited to all leadership meetings for the remainder of the year if they are not in leadership before being elected.

3. The Chair Elect shall meet with the Manager of the Board and Staff Liaisons to support the transition of the Chair and DSC.
4. The Chair Elect is recommended to meet with Board members and the superintendent following their election
5. The Chair Elect is recommended to attend Board meetings and work sessions for their tenure as Chair Elect.

Onboarding new DSC members:

1. The DSC shall host an event with the School Board and Leadership Team with the goal of letting all DSC members grow familiar with the Board and the Leadership Team.
2. The Chair shall meet with all new DSC members individually.

REMOVAL:

Purpose:

This process should be carried out when the DSC feels that a representative should be removed from a leadership position. Any representative removed from a leadership position shall remain on the DSC as a representative but no longer in their leadership position. Impeachment can only be for abuse of power or refusal to follow Board policy or Bylaws.

Process:

1. In order for a member of The Leadership Team to be removed from office, articles of impeachment must first be brought forward by a simple majority of DSC representatives during a regularly scheduled meeting.
2. At the following regularly scheduled meeting, a debate shall be held between the representatives who brought forth the articles of impeachment and those who are opposed.

    a. The Chair shall proceed over the impeachment process.
    b. The Chair will not participate in any debate.
3. The impeachment will follow this basic structure:
    a. At the end of the meeting after the debate, a vote will be taken. Two-thirds (⅔) of the DSC must be in agreement to remove the individual, following which they will be removed immediately.
    b. Representatives may also vote by a simple majority to postpone the vote and continue the debate at the next regularly scheduled meeting.
    c. Every DSC Representative must vote.
    d. The only way that representatives can vote is to remove, postpone debate, or acquit.
    e. All votes will be public.
4. After a leadership position is impeached:
    a. Within four weeks of the removal of a leadership position, an election must be held for that position. The elected individual shall take office immediately after the election results are finalized.
    b. If any representative in a leadership position resigns from that role, the above shall also apply.

Petition the Board to Remove the Student Representative (Chair):

Process:

1. In order for the DSC to petition the Board to remove the Student Representative, two-thirds (⅔), of the DSC must vote yes to remove the Student Representative (Chair).
2. The DSC shall vote on a resolution to petition the School Board to remove the Student Representative (Chair) in a regularly scheduled meeting.
3. The School Board shall dictate the process of voting on the motion to remove a Student Representative (Chair).

BYLAWS:

1. Nothing in these bylaws shall be construed to conflict with legally given rights, responsibilities, duties, or privileges reserved by PPS or by state and federal law.
2. Bylaws may be amended after DSC decision.
3. Amendments shall be drafted by a DSC subcommittee, and the proposed edits will be voted upon.
4. Any changes to the bylaws shall be passed via a resolution.
5. Bylaws must be approved by the Board of Education

FURTHER AGREEMENTS:

1. The DSC welcomes the opportunity to hear other perspectives from the student body when requested. There may be times when non-representatives and/or subcommittees will be invited to provide outside perspectives.
2. The DSC shall take every reasonable effort to assist District staff and the Board on any initiatives by giving the perspective of the DSC. The DSC shall invite District staff and Board members to DSC meetings when the Leadership Team deems it necessary.
3. The DSC shall invite District Staff and members of the Board when the Leadership Team deems appropriate and beneficial.

PPS STUDENT SUMMIT:

The PPS Student Summit is strongly suggested by policy and must include:

1. Prioritizing outreach to affinity groups.
2. Accurate representation of the student body through a just and equitable lens.